BSc Computer Science

CM2045 Professional Practice for Computer Scientists

Midterm coursework assignment: *Case Study Analysis – NAD vs. Netflix and the Fight for Accessible Streaming*

Weighting: 50% of final grade
Estimated Time Commitment: ~20 hours

Important reminder
Plagiarism is a form of cheating and is an academic offense. It arises where work submitted by a student is not their own and has been taken from another source. The original material is then hidden either by not referencing it properly or by not mentioning it at all, which is a breach of academic integrity. Bear in mind that it is possible to plagiarise unintentionally, so read this guide to make sure that you avoid it.

Assignment overview

This coursework requires you to conduct a **detailed case study analysis** of the legal case *National Association of the Deaf, et al. v. Netflix (2011-2012)*. This case was a **turning point in web accessibility**, focusing on the provision of **closed captions on streaming content** and the application of **disability law to online businesses**.

You will analyse the **case background, legal arguments, accessibility concerns, court decision, and broader implications for the technology industry**. Your work must be presented in two deliverables:

1. **A written report [35 marks]** providing an in-depth case study analysis.
2. **A recorded presentation [15 marks]** summarising key findings concisely.

This assignment assesses your ability to:

- Conduct **rigorous research** using diverse, credible sources. The focus could be on technical standards such as those provided by The Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG), press releases from both parties, legal documents, web articles, quotes from either parties and/or their representatives as well as a range of other literature and media sources that you consider appropriate for eliciting the key points and presenting a coherent, informative research report. The Disability Rights Education & Defense Fund provide an introduction and timeline for the case history as a starting point for your research https://dredf.org/nad-v-netflix/
- Analyse **legal, ethical, and technological aspects** of accessibility.
- Communicate findings **clearly and professionally** in both **written and spoken** formats.
- Use **visual elements effectively** to enhance analysis.
- Synthesise information and propose **insightful recommendations**.

Assignment Deliverables & Marking Breakdown

1. Written Case Study Analysis [35 marks total]

Your **formal report** (2,000–2,500 words) should be structured as follows:

Section	Description	Marks
Executive Summary	A **concise (≤250 words) summary** of the case, key findings, and lessons learned.	**5**
Introduction	Introduces the case, outlines its **significance**, and sets up the analysis.	**2**
Background	Context on **Netflix, *National Association of the Deaf*,** and **online accessibility** at the time.	**3**
Chronology of Events	A **structured timeline** of key case events, including legal milestones and Netflix's responses.	**5**
Analysis of Accessibility Issues	Explanation of **closed captioning as an accessibility barrier**, referencing **WCAG guidelines**.	**5**
Impact Analysis	Discusses the **impact on deaf and hard-of-hearing users**, using advocacy perspectives where possible.	**5**
Legal Analysis	Detailed analysis of **the arguments from both sides and the court's reasoning**. You may utilise	**5**
Lessons Learned & Recommendations	Key takeaways from the case with **clear, actionable recommendations** for streaming services and other online businesses regarding accessibility compliance.	**5**

Expectations for the Written Report:

- Your analysis should be **well-structured, clearly written, and professional**.
- Use a **consistent and academically appropriate citation style** (e.g., APA, Harvard, or IEEE).
- Research should draw from **credible sources**, including legal documents, news reports, advocacy group statements, and any other source of information deemed appropriate and relevant. You may also rely on expert opinions, interpretations and consensus around the legal milestones of this case.
- **Critical engagement** with the material is expected—avoid simple summaries. Instead, **analyse and evaluate** the arguments and implications.
- **Visual elements** must be well-integrated and **genuinely enhance the report**, not serve as filler content.

2. Presentation [15 marks total]

You will create a **5–7-minute recorded presentation** summarising your case study analysis of the key points mentioned in your report. AI including generative AI tools and LLMs should not be used to form any part of this assignment. The presentation should be recorded using screen recording software (e.g., PowerPoint with narration, Loom, OBS Studio) and should include **visually engaging slides** to support your key points.

Component	Description	Marks
Visual Aids	Well-designed slides that enhance understanding and are **visually appealing, clear, and well-structured**.	**5**
Delivery	Professional and engaging delivery. **Clear pacing, confident tone, and appropriate emphasis**.	**5**
Content & Structure	The presentation follows a **logical structure**, covers **all key points concisely**, and maintains a **clear focus**.	**5**

Expectations for the Presentation:

- Your slides should be **professionally designed, uncluttered, and support—not replace—your spoken delivery**.
- Your narration should be **clear, confident, and engaging**, avoiding monotone delivery or excessive hesitations.
- The presentation should **flow logically**, emphasising key legal, ethical, and technological aspects while keeping within the time limit.
- **Avoid reading directly from your slides**—use them as **visual prompts** to reinforce key ideas.

Submission Requirements

- **Written Report:** Submit as a **PDF** or **Word document**.
- **Presentation:** Submit as a **video file (MP4).**
- **File Naming Convention:** CM2045_SRN_CaseStudy.pdf and CM2045_SRN_Presentation.mp4.

Assessment Criteria Recap

Your final grade will be based on **both deliverables**, weighted as follows:

- Written Case Study Analysis: 35 marks
- Presentation: 15 marks

Total available on this coursework: 50 marks

Both the written report and the presentation must demonstrate **strong research, critical thinking, and professional communication skills**.

Final Notes

This coursework brief outlines the **core expectations** for your work. Use it as a **guideline** while allowing room for **your own analytical voice and interpretation**. If you have any **questions about the assignment**, seek clarification **well before the deadline**.

[END OF COURSEWORK ASSIGNMENT]